Welcome to Brightloop

Brightloop is a 74-person company in Leeds that makes route-planning software for bike couriers. We were founded in 2019. Core hours are 10:30 to 15:30 UK time, and the whole company meets for a stand-up every Tuesday at 09:45. Outside core hours you are free to arrange your day, as long as your team knows when to reach you. We write down decisions in the Lighthouse channel so that nobody has to ask twice. New starters get a buddy for their first three months, and the buddy books a coffee chat every Friday. Our values are short: be kind, be clear, and ship small. Visitors must sign in at the front desk and wear a badge. The office is closed on the last Friday of December, and nobody is expected to read messages that day. Every team keeps a public changelog so that others can follow its progress.

Parental leave and time off

Brightloop gives every parent 17 weeks of fully paid parental leave, including adoption and surrogacy. After that, parents can take 6 more weeks at half pay. Annual leave is 27 days plus UK bank holidays. After five years you may take a paid four-week sabbatical. Request time off in the Timeloop tool at least two months before a long break, and one week before a short one. Sick days do not count against annual leave, and you do not need a doctor's note for the first three days. Part-time employees receive leave in proportion to their hours. Unused annual leave up to five days may be carried into the next year, but it expires on 31 March. Managers approve or decline a request within three working days.

Expenses

When you travel for work, meals are reimbursed up to 38 pounds per day. Hotels are reimbursed up to 145 pounds per night outside London and 190 pounds per night in London. Submit claims in the Receipto tool within 30 days. A receipt is required for any amount above 12 pounds. Alcohol is never reimbursed. Train tickets should be booked in standard class unless the journey is longer than four hours. Taxis are allowed only after 22:00 or when carrying heavy equipment. Conference tickets need approval from your manager before you buy them. If a trip is cancelled, forward the cancellation email together with the claim. Personal expenses that are accidentally put on the company card must be repaid within 14 days.

Equipment

Laptops are replaced every 41 months with a budget of 1350 pounds. New starters also receive a one-time home-office stipend of 420 pounds and a monitor budget of 230 pounds. If anything breaks, report it in the fix-it channel within one working day. Old laptops are wiped by IT and donated to a local school. Never install your own disk-encryption tools, because the company laptop image already includes one. Headsets and keyboards can be ordered from the equipment shelf without approval, up to a value of 60 pounds. Chargers are not replaced when lost more than once a year. Standing desks are available on request after a short ergonomic check with the office manager. Remote staff may ship equipment back in the original box using the prepaid label.

Security

Report any suspicious email to phish@brightloop.example within 2 hours. A password manager is mandatory for every employee. If you lose a laptop or a phone, call the security hotline on extension 4417 within one hour, day or night. Never share a login, even with a teammate. Contractors receive a separate guest account that expires after 30 days unless a manager renews it. Public Wi-Fi is allowed only together with the company VPN. Customer data must never be copied to personal cloud drives or sent through private messaging apps. Screens must be locked whenever you leave your desk, and visitors may not be left alone in the office. Security training is repeated every twelve months, and new starters complete it in their first week.

On-call

Engineers join an on-call rotation that lasts 9 days. The on-call stipend is 112 pounds for every on-call day. A severity 1 alert must be acknowledged within 12 minutes, and the engineer escalates to the Lighthouse channel if it is not fixed in an hour. Shifts can be swapped with at least 48 hours notice. After a severity 1 incident, the engineer gets the next morning off. Every incident ends with a written review within five working days, and the review is blameless. The on-call phone is handed over at 09:30 on the first day of the rotation. Engineers who are ill or on leave are removed from the rotation automatically. New engineers shadow two rotations before they are on call alone.